

BM2: Lesson 3 – Abram

No Heir, Wait Here

 **Theme:** Trusting God when the wait is long

 **Background Text:** Genesis 15:1–6; 16:1–5; 17:1–8

 **Key Verse:** Genesis 15:6 (WEB)

“He believed in Yahweh, who credited it to him for righteousness.”

Appetizer – Faith Between Promises Genesis 15:1–3 (WEB)

¹ After these things Yahweh’s word came to Abram in a vision, saying, ‘Don’t be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your exceedingly great reward.’ ² Abram said, ‘Lord Yahweh, what will you give me, since I go childless, and he who will inherit my estate is Eliezer of Damascus?’

³ Abram said, ‘Behold, to me you have given no children; and, behold, one born in my house is my heir.’

Many of us know what it feels like to sit between what God said and what we see. Abram had promises, but no child. Blessing was on his life, but barrenness was in his house.

 **CST: When promises linger, faith begins to question.**

Abram didn’t pretend everything was fine—he told God honestly where his heart was: “What good are all these blessings if I don’t have the one thing You promised?”

Reflection:

What do *you* do when your vision from God hasn’t yet come to pass?



Main Course



Bite 1 – Promise Beyond Sight, Genesis 15:4–6 (WEB)

“Behold, Yahweh’s word came to him, saying, ‘This man will not be your heir, but he who will come out of your own body will be your heir.’ Yahweh brought him outside, and said, ‘Look now toward the sky, and count the stars, if you are able to count them.’ He said to Abram, ‘So shall your offspring be.’ He believed in Yahweh; and he reckoned it to him for righteousness.”

God did not deny Abram’s disappointment; He answered it with a bigger picture. God pulled Abram outside, pointed to the stars, and told him to count the uncountable.



CST: Faith is often proven in the unseen.

When sight fades, trust sharpens. God asked Abram to believe a promise that his eyes could not yet verify, and heaven called that belief “righteousness.”

Reflection:

What “stars” is God asking you to look at and believe for—even when your current situation says the opposite?



Bite 2 – Impatience in the Process, Genesis 16:1–4 (WEB)

¹Now Sarai, Abram’s wife, bore him no children. She had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar. ²Sarai said to Abram, ‘See now, Yahweh has restrained me from bearing. Please go in to my servant. It may be that I will obtain children by her.’ Abram listened to the voice of Sarai. ³After Abram had lived ten years in the land of Canaan, Sarai took Hagar the Egyptian, her servant, and gave her to Abram her husband to be his wife. ⁴He went to Hagar, and she conceived. When she saw that she had conceived, her mistress was despised in her eyes.

Sarai and Abram reached a breaking point in the waiting and decided to “help” God. Their plan produced a child—but also tension, comparison, and conflict. Waiting is not always easy but oftentimes required.

 CST: Human shortcuts can complicate divine timing.

When we rush what God promised to perfect, we create situations He never asked us to manage. Grace can redeem our detours, but consequences are still real.

Reflection:

Where are you most tempted to “fix it yourself” instead of waiting on God’s way and God’s time?

 Bite 3 – Promise Reaffirmed Genesis 17:1–5, 7 (WEB)

¹When Abram was ninety-nine years old, Yahweh appeared to Abram and said to him, ‘I am God Almighty. Walk before me, and be blameless. ²I will make my covenant between me and you, and will multiply you exceedingly.’ ³Abram fell on his face. God talked with him, saying, ⁴‘As for me, behold, my covenant is with you. You will be the father of a multitude of nations. ⁵Your name will no longer be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham; for I have made you the father of a multitude of nations. ⁷I will establish my covenant between me and you and your offspring after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant...’

God revisited Abram years later—not to cancel the promise, but to **expand** it and attach it to a covenant. He also changed Abram’s name to Abraham to match what heaven already saw.

 CST: God’s promises come with identity shifts.

He renames us to remind us of who we are becoming, not what we’ve been. Abraham had to learn to answer to a name that sounded like the promise *before* the promise fully showed up.

Reflection:

Is there an area where God is calling you to think, speak, or walk according to His promise—before you see it?

 Dessert – Faith Rewarded Through Time, Romans 4:20–21 (WEB)

“Yet, looking to the promise of God, he didn’t waver through unbelief, but grew strong through faith, giving glory to God, and being fully assured that what he had promised, he was also able to perform.”

Reflection:

God doesn't forget; He fulfills. Abraham's faith grew stronger over time, even while the promise seemed delayed.

How can you glorify God while you're still waiting for your "Isaac" to come forth?

To-Go Box

- Faith is not just belief—it's **endurance** through delay.
- Questioning God honestly doesn't disqualify you; staying stuck in unbelief does.
- Human shortcuts (like Hagar) may seem faster, but they complicate what God intended to be clean.
- When God reaffirms His promise, He often calls you by a new name or identity that lines up with your future.
- God's timeline is not denial; it's divine alignment.

Word Study

- **Abram** – "Exalted Father"
- **Abraham** – "Father of Many Nations"
- **El Shaddai** – "God Almighty," the all-sufficient One who sustains, provides, and fulfills His promises.

Closing Prayer

"God Almighty, El Shaddai, Thank You for being faithful even when my faith feels small. Teach me to wait on Your timing instead of forcing my own solutions. Help me to believe Your promises when I can't yet see the evidence.

Rename the places in my life that still sound like doubt and align my identity with what You have spoken. Make me fully assured that what You have promised, You are also able to perform. In Jesus' name, amen."



Activity – True or False: Trust the Timeline

1. Abram's faith never wavered from the start.
☐ True ☐ False
2. Sarai suggested a human solution to a divine promise.
☐ True ☐ False
3. God changed Abram's name after he demonstrated obedience.
☐ True ☐ False
4. Hagar's son was the covenant child.
☐ True ☐ False
5. God's timing tests faith before fulfilling it.
☐ True ☐ False

(Check the Appendix for answers)



Notes Section — Group Discussion & Personal Study
